

Chapter 105-2

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This escape room experience was full of twists and turns.

It was only after they left that Liang Shi learned Xu Qingzhu had single-handedly solved the sixth stage that even many escape room exploration bloggers hadn't been able to crack—and she had used the champion solution.

The first solution was indeed collaborative. After finding the communication tool, people in the two spaces would exchange clues and solve it together.

The second solution was for a single person to unlock a new dungeon, essentially trading three side quests for the clues in Liang Shi's dungeon. It was rather tedious.

But there was also a champion solution—skipping the steps of the original logic and directly bypassing those three side quests to obtain the clues, which could rescue the teammate trapped in the dungeon task.

Xu Qingzhu had used the champion solution, and she was even ten minutes faster than a famous escape room exploration blogger who had been there before—someone the entire internet called the "Puzzle-Solving Boss."

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When Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu were about to leave, the escape room shop owner not only apologized to Liang Shi but also asked Xu Qingzhu if she was interested in taking on a job to design new dungeons for their shop. The price was negotiable.

Xu Qingzhu politely declined.

Liang Shi also hadn't expected that she would faint during a solo task while playing an escape room. It was a bit embarrassing.

As they came out, she was still complaining to Xu Qingzhu: "Dream Castle isn't dreamy at all. They should call it Nightmare Castle instead."

Actually, what she had experienced in the escape room had made her feel quite unwell.

The distressing part was that she had no idea what to do.

Those chaotic memories had invaded her mind all at once—several scattered threads. No matter which one she pulled out, it was upsetting.

But she didn't want Xu Qingzhu to feel upset with her, nor did she want to spread her low mood, so she tried her best to act like she didn't care.

She even became more talkative than usual to cover up her low spirits.

But Xu Qingzhu didn't give her the chance to be talkative.

It was already evening when they came out of the escape room. Time had flown by while they were clearing stages—six or seven hours had passed without them realizing it.

Dusk had settled in. The streetlights on both sides of the road lit up. It was already late autumn, and only a few stubborn yellow leaves remained on the trees along the sides, swaying precariously on the nearly bare branches.

Xu Qingzhu had been very quiet since leaving the escape room. Liang Shi had tried to tease her a few times, and she had given her face by smiling, but the smile didn't reach her eyes. She still maintained her cool and distant demeanor.

It was as if they had gone back to when they first met.

No, it was like when Liang Shi had just transmigrated here—Xu Qingzhu had looked at her with particular coldness.

But there was a subtle difference from back then. Xu Qingzhu's body still subconsciously moved closer to her.

When the autumn wind blew over, Xu Qingzhu would walk beside her, staying very close.

But once the gust passed, Xu Qingzhu would put some distance between them again.

They hadn't walked very far—just from the escape room shop to the mall diagonally across the street. Since the distance was short, driving around would have taken longer than walking.

During this very short journey, Liang Shi's mind was churning with countless thoughts.

Just as they were about to reach the mall entrance, Liang Shi suddenly reached out and grabbed Xu Qingzhu's wrist. Her slightly cool fingernail pads gently rubbed against her wrist.

Xu Qingzhu tilted her head up slightly, her gaze cool. "What is it?"

"What should we eat?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu shook her head. "I don't know."

Her tone in answering the question was also very cold.

But Liang Shi didn't know where she had upset her.

Liang Shi wasn't feeling good. When those memories had hit her, it was like being thrown back into those same scenes and experiencing them all over again. The things she had been afraid of before, she was still afraid of now. Even if she was mentally comforting herself, the body had its own memory.

She was just deliberately suppressing it, unwilling to let that emotion show.

Yet she didn't know what was going on with Xu Qingzhu.

Ever since Liang Shi had woken up there and Xu Qingzhu had hugged her in lingering fear, Xu Qingzhu had been very cold.

